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Cognition AI to purchase fellow coding startup Windsurf after Google's \$2.4B acqui-hire deal for founders

By [Jacob Robbins](#)

Published July 15, 2025

[Cognition AI](#), a coding automation startup, is buying what remains of fellow AI startup [Windsurf](#).

The deal comes just days after acquisition talks between Windsurf and [OpenAI](#) were called off. Instead, [Google](#) struck a \$2.4 billion deal to poach Windsurf's leadership and license its tech—the latest in a string of such “acqui-hires” by big tech companies.

Windsurf and Cognition did not disclose a sale price.

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In an [email sent to employees](#), Windsurf's interim CEO acknowledged the acquisition caps off “a really volatile time” at the company and that Cognition is “a perfect fit to bring Windsurf to the next phase.”

OpenAI had reportedly been courting the coding startup for months, agreeing to purchase Windsurf for \$3 billion. But the deal fell apart after tensions with Microsoft, one of OpenAI's biggest investors, emerged over concerns about the tech giant having access to Windsurf's proprietary technology, according to Bloomberg.

As part of the deal, Cognition will acquire all of Windsurf's IP, employees, and brand. Scott Wu, Cognition's CEO, also confirmed that all of Windsurf's employees will participate in the deal and have their vesting schedules pushed up.

In March, Cognition reportedly raised new funding led by [8VC](#) that doubled its valuation to \$4 billion. The startup is best known for Devin, an AI-powered software engineering tool that competed with Windsurf.

Windsurf's biggest investors include [Founders Fund](#), [General Catalyst](#), and [Kleiner Perkins](#).

Big tech companies have shelled out billions to gut AI startups by bringing on top talent. Among those deals: Meta invested over \$14 billion in [Scale AI, taking a 49% ownership stake](#) and hiring the startup's CEO, Alexandr Wang. Microsoft spent around \$650 million to hire [Inflection AI's](#) co-founder and some staff last year.

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About [Jacob Robbins](#)

Reporter Jacob Robbins covers artificial intelligence and the venture capital ecosystem for PitchBook. Based in Seattle, Jacob is originally from Massachusetts and holds dual degrees in political science and cinema studies from the American University. His work has previously appeared in Air Mail and Business Insider.

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